SWIM

Week 05 Swim

Week 5 of 52 | Mon 02 Nov 2026 to Sun 08 Nov 2026 | Month 2: Keto adaptation 1: settle in

The idea this month: short fast lengths with full rest, stroke count as the honesty check, fins as a teaching tool. Endurance volume comes back once the fast stroke is the default. 25 m pool. Every swim is 700-1,100 m and 22-35 minutes.

Monday, 02 Nov Swim 1 - Fast feel, build 25s (30 min)

Focus: Speed exposure with fins first, then without. Shoulder still settling, so builds rather than flat-out.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Fingertip drag / 25 FS) r20
Main	8 x 25 Build 50-style (easy to fast over the length) r30. Reps 1-4 with fins, 5-8 without. Count strokes on every one and write the counts on the sheet.
Easy	4 x 50 FS r20 at 1:50-2:00, long and relaxed
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 900 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no. First swim of the block: if anything feels off, the Easy set is the session and the Main set waits a week.

Thursday, 05 Nov Swim 2 - Fast feel, 25 fast / 25 easy (25 min)

Focus: Same idea from a push: fast length, easy length.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Zipper / 25 FS) r20
Main	6 x 50 as 25 fast / 25 easy r30. Fins on reps 2, 4 and 6. The fast 25 is quick and smooth, the easy 25 is where you notice what changed.
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 800 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no. No pool today? 30-40 min elliptical at a conversational effort is the fallback, not a replacement to prefer.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Fingertip drag	Swim normally but during the recovery let the fingertips trail along the surface, elbow high and pointing to the ceiling. Purpose: relaxed, high-elbow recovery and shoulder rotation.
Build 50	Start the 50 easy and finish it fast, without letting the stroke shorten. Purpose: learning to raise speed by pressing harder on the water, not by spinning the arms.
Stroke count	Count strokes per 25 m (one arm = one stroke). Write down your normal count, then try to hold pace with one fewer. Purpose: efficiency and distance per stroke.
Zipper	During recovery, drag the thumb up the side of the body from hip to armpit before reaching forward. Purpose: high elbow recovery and body rotation.

Shoulder and stroke log (0 = no pain, 10 = worst pain)

Session	Shoulder during	Next morning	Strokes per 25, fast	Best 25 or 50 time	Notes
Monday					
Thursday					